



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	23/10/2022	Time of Incident:	07.00am
Region / Directorate:	Kimberley Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Injury/Illness	EQSafe Incident Number:	28757
Actual Consequence:	Moderate	Potential Consequence:	Major

Incident Short Description:	Truck slid off jack while worker was underneath
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Executive Summary:

Following brake issues a bitumen spray truck was parked on a flat, even surface about 5m from the road. Safety cones were placed around the vehicle, the wheels were chocked, and the suspension air bags were at the highest position to give room under the truck to manoeuvre. A bottle jack was placed under the suspension in case the suspension airbags were to discharge.

As the operator was under the truck, he gave instructions to the supervisor to release the brakes while he looked for the brake problem. Following the brake release, the truck moved and slid off the jack. With the truck movement, the operator was struck by the drive shaft causing lacerations to his face and mouth.



Image: When park brake was released, the truck slid off the jack

Contributing Factors:

- The truck was not on specific work location, but in a laydown area.
- There was no mechanic on site to fix the park brake problem.
- The truck was not secured sufficiently prior to work being undertaken underneath. Incorrect procedure for someone to climb underneath the truck working on brake systems.
- No procedure / SWMS for the process to fault find the brake problem. Reliance on verbal information over the phone.
- The supervisor did not recognize the potential hazards associated with releasing / applying the brakes while someone was underneath the truck.

Corrective Actions:

- Review and Implement the Plant Pre-Checklists to incorporate identification of serious faults and how to report these faults for follow up and action.
- Recommend qualified mechanics to perform fault finding and maintenance on equipment critical items.
- Communicate to all operators / drivers about reporting equipment defects and the hazards that these can cause.
- Contractors to review and update the Hazard identification registers to include critical plant equipment maintenance.
- Jacking, securing and isolating techniques for Heavy machinery needs to be reviewed, as in this case it has identified both, the truck operator and Site supervisor did not Identify potential hazards, and control the hazards to an acceptable level.

Additional Issues/Learnings:



Critical Risk:

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to **Vehicles and Driving / Mobile Plant.**

Distribution of Notice:

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations